Resolution Visibility Is Not Recovery: A Partial-Identification Reanalysis of 16,118 Coding-Agent Misalignment Episodes

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Abstract. Observational coding-agent corpora can record a visible resolution without revealing the eventual outcome; the original study explicitly documented this missingness. We reanalyze its hash-pinned 16,118-episode release to quantify severity-conditioned visibility, matching restrictions, and identification limits. Only 1,504 episodes have a visible resolution; 14,614 final outcomes are unknown. Visible resolution is recorded for 330/1,361 DS2 episodes versus 1,174/14,587 DS1 episodes (+16.20 percentage points). Across 853 sessions containing both labels (9.93% of two-class sessions; 2,775/15,948 eligible episodes), the equal-session difference is +13.96 points (repository-nested descriptive band +10.72 to +17.30). Of 553 tied sessions, 528 have zero recorded visible resolution in both classes. The eventual post-pushback DS2-minus-DS1 contrast remains partially identified, with logical bounds of -77.61 to +90.10 points. Under an unverified common recovery share among unknown cases, the sign changes at 88.56%. A deliberately targeted reclassification of 223 DS2/RS1 labels can erase the pooled visible-resolution ordering; those flips would comprise 67.6% of visible DS2 resolutions, not an estimated source-label error rate. The findings characterize released-label measurement limits, not causal severity effects or fieldwide recovery.

Keywords. Coding agents; human oversight; missing outcomes; partial identification; developer–agent misalignment; reproducibility.

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1 Introduction

A language-model agent can ask the right question without receiving a reply from a person, issue a permission request without executing the associated tool, or trigger additional checking without correcting the underlying error. All three results may be scientifically valid. They answer different questions, however, from whether human oversight prevents harmful action in a deployed system. The distinction is especially consequential when a benchmark score is used to motivate an operational recommendation: the actor who supplied the answer, the state in which a decision occurred and the outcome actually measured determine what a reader may infer.

The same word can hide different experimental objects. An *ask* event can be an episode-ending abstention, a question resolved by a stored answer, or a request submitted to a person in a live workflow. An *approval* can be a binary classifier output, a simulated button action, or a consequential authorization granted by a human operator. A reduction in *cost* may mean fewer generated questions, a model-judged attention score, lower elapsed laboratory time, or fewer

measured minutes of active human work. Treating those measures as equivalent would erase the experimental conditions responsible for the result.

Prior scholarship has already established several of the distinctions at issue. Surveys of human–agent collaboration, abstention and human-in-the-loop design organize the relevant mechanisms [1, 2, 3, 4]. Nageshwaran and colleagues synthesize the validity of agent benchmarks [5]; Yehudai and Mohammadi and colleagues survey evaluation methods and benchmark dimensions [6, 7]. Cao and colleagues map procedural integrity and quality in an explicit $\mathcal{F}^*$ framework [8], while Nguyen and colleagues distinguish the ability to intervene from normatively meaningful human control [9]. Most directly, DelegationBench itself recommends separate reporting for candidate judgment, elicitation, permission resolution, constructed action, semantic correspondence and state update (Appendix J, Table 19) [11]. An October 2026 narrative review in the target journal also maps AI-agent technical limitations to oversight, responsibility and incident-tracing problems [10]; it does not reconstruct the particular missing-resolution labels or compare severity-conditioned observation across repositories. We do not claim to originate those reporting stages or to replace these broader reviews.

Our primary empirical question is narrower: when a released observational dataset records a resolution only for some agent–developer episodes, which numerical target is observed, which is only partially identified, and which cannot be inferred? We therefore reanalyze the pinned 16,118-episode release of Tang and colleagues [29] using source-stratified, repository-matched and session-matched contrasts, then derive sharp missing-outcome bounds and an explicit sensitivity frontier for eventual post-pushback recovery. The cross-study checks that follow serve as interpretive context for the same target-definition problem; they are not a second systematic-review endpoint.

The principal added empirical object is the severity-specific recorded-visibility contrast and its within-session and repository-level sensitivity, not a newly collected set of coding-agent failures or a newly noticed missing-outcome problem. A second added calculation identifies sharp logical bounds and assumption-dependent sign frontiers for eventual post-pushback recovery across severity labels. The release is based on episodes surfaced by developer pushback, not a census of unobserved agent failures. The original study reports limited expert annotation checks, with comparatively weaker severity-label agreement; our adversarial reclassification certificate in Appendix A.4 shows that descriptive clustering stability is distinct from label-validity robustness. None of these analyses independently validates the severity labels, estimates a causal effect, or certifies agent safety. A compact machine-readable result file and deterministic replay script accompany the author-review package and export no third-party episode rows.

2 Evidence basis and analytical approach

2.1 Primary empirical source and contextual source selection

The primary empirical source is the public developer–agent misalignment annotation release accompanying Tang and colleagues [29]. The frozen file contains 16,118 admitted misalignment episodes drawn from 20,574 original coding-agent sessions. The source defines an episode as a breakdown made visible through subsequent developer correction or pushback. Unnoticed failures, silent workarounds and sessions without visible pushback are outside this operational sampling frame. We analyze released labels exactly as assigned and pin the source by SHA-256 before admitting any result. The reanalysis scripts and aggregate-only replay certificate are publicly available at `https://github.com/shaikhamalkawi-ux/99llm-agent-oversight-reanalysis`; full numerical replay requires independently obtaining and hash-verifying the original authors' public annotation file. The source's codebook also shows why classification and resolution ascertainment may be linked: DS1 denotes effort/trust costs without an applied state change; DS2 requires an applied but readily reversible change; and RS1 requires explicit evidence of a fix. Because these assessments are drawn from the same conversation, trace observability can

Table 1: What the original coding-agent study established and what the present source-locked reanalysis adds. All source counts and original labels are attributed to Tang et al. [29]; no new agent episodes are collected or independently reannotated.

Question	**Original study: established evidence**	**Present analysis: added estimand or limitation**
Which episodes and outcomes are visible?	A developer-pushback-based collection; 16,118 admitted episodes, 90.67% with unknown final status; 91.49% RV2 among 1,504 visibly resolved episodes.	Source-locked recount only. We do *not* claim to discover the missingness or to collect the records.
Is recorded resolution visibility associated with severity?	Marginal severity and resolution distributions, without a reported severity-by-visibility matched-session contrast.	Original-label DS2–DS1 difference of +16.20 percentage points; source- and repository-stratified comparisons.
Does the label association persist within sessions?	No within-session severity-specific visibility estimand in the reported marginal tables.	Equal-session +13.96 points across 853 matched sessions, with repository-nested descriptive resampling; explicit coverage and tie accounting.
Can eventual recovery or true severity be inferred?	The authors recognize unknown outcomes and report limited source-annotation checks.	Sharp eventual-outcome contrast bounds, assumption frontier, and an exact targeted-label perturbation witness; neither establishes corrected labels or causal repair effects.

influence both the severity label and the apparent resolution rate. A positive within-session contrast therefore need not represent easier correction of objectively more severe failures. The source authors performed their own limited expert checks on the extraction and annotation pipeline: their public May 2026 preprint v1, Appendix A.2, Table 5, reports two-human exact agreement of 0.71 for `damage severity`, and model-to-adjudicated-label exact-match accuracy of 0.64, versus 0.92 and 0.96 for `resolution status`, on the 100-record annotation-check sample. These are source-reported, version-specific sample diagnostics, not an estimated DS1/DS2-specific confusion matrix or an accuracy claim for our reanalysis. We did not conduct a new manual severity-label validation, and the v1 diagnostic is not silently represented as a fresh test of the final conference edition.

A broader discovery register of 170 candidate source families was assembled earlier for contextual interpretation. AI-assisted title/abstract routing provisionally assigned 101 to possible primary-study work, 53 to contextual evidence and 16 to prior reviews. These are reading-queue categories rather than inclusion decisions: there is no exhaustive-search claim, registered protocol, PRISMA denominator or fieldwide sampling frame. Twelve detailed cases were selected retrospectively to illustrate contrasts in respondent, agent state, intervention timing, information budget, analysis unit or burden measure [14, 15, 11, 12, 13, 16, 17, 21, 22, 19, 20, 18]. A later four-case exercise and a seven-case challenge were likewise nonrandom. None is used to estimate prevalence in the literature or to validate the empirical DS1–DS2 result.

Scope of the identification target. An estimand over labels extracted from one transcript is not automatically an estimand over underlying physical damage or task recovery. A trace demonstrating applied code/state change makes a DS2 annotation possible, while a trace showing explicit repair makes RS1 possible. The same visibility and developer-pushback selection mechanisms can therefore influence both axes. Session matching cannot break this shared measurement mechanism, and the source's per-axis validation results do not supply a joint DS1–DS2-by-RS1–RS2 error table. Our primary endpoint is consequently *recorded visibility*

conditional on source-assigned severity, not an effect of increasing severity on repair success.

2.2 Unit of analysis, source attribution and verification

The unit of scrutiny is a *source-specific claim about an experimental contrast.* Each claim is traced using eight descriptive fields: (A) source edition and locator; (B) runtime respondent; (C) decision and operational state; (D) timing relative to action; (E) comparator and information budget; (F) eligible unit, denominator and endpoint; (G) observed human effort or proxy; and (H) permitted inference. This record documents what was examined; it is not a validated scale, ranking or independent quality score. We separately identify (i) an original author's stated result, (ii) a value recomputed from displayed source evidence, (iii) a released-record recount, and (iv) an unresolved issue. A hypothetical overinterpretation by a reader is never attributed to the original authors without textual evidence.

Where an original table supplied counts, displayed fractions or model-level values, we recomputed only the permitted arithmetic. For released categorical data, we verified item identity, row counts and declared labels but did not rerun the source's collection or annotation models. We did not infer unobserved trial outcomes, invent missing user identifiers or reconstruct clustered p-values from aggregate tables. The evaluation combines original papers, publisher-version comparisons and selected author repositories; source access and any unclosed version gate are noted in the interpretation, not silently resolved by substituting a different edition. The supporting archive holds the bounded formulas, case-to-source links and version records. No third-party private user data are redistributed.

2.3 Secondary observational analysis and dependence control

For the released developer–agent annotation file, we first validate the declared SHA-256 source hash, distinct episode identifiers, resolution-status/resolver consistency, and the full data partition. The severity comparison is restricted to the two most prevalent labels, `DS1` (effort/trust) and `DS2` (easily reversible damage), using the original labels as assigned. The remaining 170 episodes with `DS0`, `DS3` or `DS4` are not silently reassigned or treated as successes. The binary descriptive outcome is *visibly resolved* (`RS1`); `RS2` denotes *unknown final outcome*, not failure.

We estimate raw visibility rates for each severity category and repeat the contrast in each original acquisition source (SpecStory and SWE). Because episodes are nested in repositories and repeated within sessions, we then perform two matched-cluster checks. First, among repositories containing both `DS1` and `DS2`, a repository is identified by (source, repository identifier); we compute the within-repository `DS2` minus `DS1` visible-resolution-rate difference and give each matched repository equal weight. We use 3,000 deterministic bootstrap resamples of whole repositories (seed 993718) as a descriptive resampling interval.

Second, we repeat the same calculation within recorded sessions, identified by (source, repository identifier, session identifier), retaining only sessions containing both severity labels. Each matched session receives equal weight. To avoid treating different sessions from one repository as independent resampling units, the preferred descriptive sensitivity interval resamples entire source–repository clusters and carries all eligible sessions in each sampled repository (3,000 replicates; seed 993720). For comparison we retain the original whole-session resampling interval (seed 993719), but do not treat it as a complete dependence correction. We also compute an equal-repository mean of within-session differences, a leave-one-repository-out range, and two explicitly post-hoc subset checks: episodes whose original extraction field `confidence` is `high`, and matched sessions with exactly one episode of each severity. The confidence field rates the support for an extracted episode, *not* the quality of its damage-severity assignment. These are robustness descriptions, not multiple confirmatory hypothesis tests. Matching within a session absorbs factors constant at the recorded-session level, but it does not balance episode-level symptoms, causes, temporal order, task difficulty or annotation selection. None of the resampling

intervals is a population confidence interval. No cases are reannotated, no model trajectories rerun and no causal severity parameter identified. Separately, we define an algebraic *adversarial reclassification* check: keep each episode's observed RS1/RS2 outcome fixed while allowing its DS1/DS2 severity label to switch. We exhaustively enumerate the two outcome-concordant directions that can reduce the observed positive contrast, and find the fewest such flips needed to erase the sign. This is a worst-case source-label fragility certificate, not a data-derived measurement of misclassification, a new adjudication, or a validation of any particular corrected label.

Analytical tooling and assisted preparation. All numerical findings are generated by deterministic Python scripts (standard library for source verification, recounting and resampling), with the conceptual figure generated by Matplotlib from the printed aggregate fractions. OpenAI ChatGPT was used substantively to assist literature selection, source comparisons, interpretation, code drafting and checking, and manuscript drafting and revision; it did not recruit participants or provide independently human-verified annotations. The authors must confirm the exact accessed product/version history and approve the results and this disclosure before submission.

2.4 Evidence classes should not be collapsed

Table 2 gives the main cross-setting distinction. A positive result in a lower-observability class is not a failed study; it is evidence about a narrower object. Stronger human-benefit or safety claims require a matching observed outcome and a suitable comparator.

Table 2: Distinct experimental objects that can appear under the same intervention terminology. Examples illustrate measurement, not a hierarchy of study quality.

Observed object	**What can be learned**	**What it does not by itself establish**
Offline choice or policy label [11, 23, 24]	Recognition of the source-defined ask/call/allow category under a stated information budget.	Correct execution, real permission or downstream recovery.
Simulated reply during executable tasks [12, 25, 26]	Agent behavior after information supplied by a model or stored response.	Human availability, effort or response quality in deployment.
Sandbox action trajectory [11, 27, 28]	Tool choice, argument fidelity or scope compliance in a controlled environment.	Consequential external safety in an unmodeled service.
Human task or oversight session [14, 15, 16, 22]	Human behavior, checks and task outcomes within the tested protocol.	General workplace effectiveness without replication and matched assignment.
Deployment observation [29, 30]	Frequencies among selected recorded episodes and released labels.	Causal intervention benefit or unobserved eventual resolution.

3 Results: recorded labels and identification limits

3.1 Recounting visible and unknown resolutions

The pinned public annotation object released by Tang and colleagues permits a complete recount of its recorded labels [29]. At the author-repository commit linked in the cited source, all 16,118 distinct episode IDs and the partition of 1,504 visibly resolved versus 14,614 with unobserved final resolution are reproducible. The visible subset classifies 45 episodes as agent self-correction, 1,376 as agent correction following developer pushback and 83 as developer takeover. The often-cited proportion $1,376/1,504 = 91.49\%$ is *conditional on visible resolution*; it is not the fraction of all

identified episodes that eventually resolved after pushback. Most outcomes remain unobserved in the released labels, and the original authors already describe this selection limitation.

3.2 Severity-conditioned visibility, matched clusters and uncertainty

The two most prevalent original severity classes contain 15,948/16,118 recorded episodes. Table 3 reports direct counts and percentages from the pinned release. For `DS1`, 1,174/14,587 episodes (8.05%) have a visible resolution; for `DS2`, 330/1,361 (24.25%) do. Thus the pooled visible-resolution risk difference is 16.20 percentage points. It is present separately in the larger SpecStory source (23.04% versus 7.67%; +15.37 points) and in SWE (29.53% versus 9.15%; +20.38 points). These quantities describe whether the original released annotation includes a visible resolution, *not* whether a case ever recovered or whether a developer's intervention caused recovery.

Table 3: Visible resolution in the pinned 16,118-episode release by original severity label and data source. Only DS1 and DS2 appear in these contrasts. Percentages are episode-level; the repeated-episode dependence is addressed in separate matched-repository and matched-session analyses.

Source	DS1 n	DS1 RS1	DS2 n	DS2 RS1	Visible-resolution difference (DS2–DS1)
SpecStory	10,861	833 (7.67%)	1,107	255 (23.04%)	+15.37 percentage points
SWE	3,726	341 (9.15%)	254	75 (29.53%)	+20.38 percentage points
All records	14,587	1,174 (8.05%)	1,361	330 (24.25%)	+16.20 percentage points

Across 1,229 distinct source–repository keys represented in these two classes, 414 repositories contain at least one episode of each severity. Within this matched subset, the equal-repository mean `DS2`–`DS1` visibility difference is +15.87 percentage points; the deterministic 3,000-resample repository-cluster interval is +12.60 to +19.29 points. These repositories contain 12,643 of the 15,948 eligible episodes. For 163 of the 414 repositories the `DS2` visible-resolution proportion exceeds `DS1`, for 94 it is lower, and for 157 the proportions tie.

The stronger dependence check matches within the same recorded session. There are 853 sessions containing at least one `DS1` and one `DS2` episode, comprising 2,775 eligible episodes. In these sessions, 183/1,772 `DS1` episodes (10.33%) and 240/1,003 `DS2` episodes (23.93%) are visibly resolved. Giving every matched session equal weight yields a mean within-session difference of +13.96 percentage points; the 3,000-resample whole-session interval is +10.90 to +17.02 points. The session-specific difference is positive in 201 sessions, negative in 99 and tied in 553. Its equal-session mean remains positive in both source strata (SpecStory +12.52; SWE +20.46 points) and both recorded interaction modes (IDE +11.62; CLI +19.42 points). This removes explanations that depend only on factors constant within a session, but not explanations based on episode composition, ordering or selection. The result therefore strengthens a descriptive association rather than identifying a causal severity effect.

Because the 853 matched sessions belong to only 352 distinct source–repository clusters, repository-level resampling is the more appropriate dependence-sensitive summary. When all matched sessions from a selected repository are retained together, the same equal-session mean of +13.96 percentage points has a descriptive 2.5th–97.5th percentile interval of +10.72 to +17.30 points. The earlier resampling of whole sessions gave +10.90 to +17.02 points; we report it as a comparator rather than an independence-justified interval. The result is also positive when each of the 352 repositories contributes equally (+14.05 points; repository resampling interval +10.18 to +18.09 points). Deleting any one repository changes the equal-session mean only to between +13.56 and +14.36 points. These checks demonstrate stability of the recorded-label association to higher-level clustering and cluster weights, not external representativeness.

Table 4: Repository-nested descriptive sensitivity of the within-session DS2–DS1 visible-resolution contrast. All values are percentage points, computed from the original labels. The percentile bands summarize resampling of observed clusters, not population confidence intervals. The final two rows are post-hoc subgroup checks, not confirmatory tests.

Matched-session check	Sessions	Repositories	Mean difference	2.5–97.5 band
All paired sessions, equal-session weights	853	352	+13.96	+10.72 to +17.30
All paired sessions, equal-repository weights	853	352	+14.05	+10.18 to +18.09
Original extraction-confidence = high	801	339	+14.30	+10.87 to +17.66
Exactly one DS1 and one DS2 per session	307	171	+16.94	+11.73 to +22.36

Coverage and tie composition. The matched-session contrast is conditional on observing both classes in a single recorded session. Of 8,590 distinct source–session keys represented by DS1/DS2 episodes, only 853 (9.93%) meet that restriction; their 2,775 episodes represent 17.40% of the 15,948 two-class episodes. Those sessions belong to 352/1,229 (28.64%) of the distinct source–repository keys. Of the 853 session-level differences, 201 are positive (23.56%), 99 negative (11.61%), and 553 tied (64.83%). Among these 553 ties, 528 (95.48%) have no visible RS1 outcome in *either* class, 22 have visible resolution for all recorded episodes of both classes, and only 3 have equal intermediate rates. Thus most ties encode shared non-observation of a visible fix, not demonstrated equality of eventual repair. Table 5 makes the sample restriction explicit; an independently rerunnable, source-hash-locked coverage script publishes these aggregate counts without session identifiers.

Table 5: Denominators for the within-session visibility result. Repository/session keys are source-qualified; descriptive shares are conditional on the released DS1/DS2 records, not a fieldwide sampling frame.

Eligibility level	Numerator	Denominator	Admitted fraction / meaning
Matched sessions with both severity labels	853	8,590	9.93%; all other two-class sessions lack a within-session contrast
Episodes in those matched sessions	2,775	15,948	17.40%; the matched estimate is not a poolwide episode mean
Repositories with at least one matched session	352	1,229	28.64%; 414 repositories have both labels somewhere, not necessarily in one session

The extraction-confidence and one-to-one restrictions were selected after inspecting available annotation fields and are exploratory. The original `confidence` field measures evidence support for an episode's extraction; neither restriction establishes correctness of its severity label. The one-to-one check removes multiplicity within included sessions but further reduces coverage; the original 853 matched sessions themselves contain only 2,775 of the 15,948 eligible DS1/DS2 episodes. The analysis should not imply that the matched subset represents the rest of the nonrandom released collection.

3.3 Sensitivity to classification uncertainty

The repository-nested resampling bands address dependence in the *recorded labels*; they cannot address whether a reported DS2 episode should instead have been DS1 or vice versa. The source

authors' 100-record validation check in arXiv v1 found materially weaker agreement on the severity axis than on the resolution-status axis (Section 2). This comparison does not furnish a joint error matrix, so we neither rescale the observed contrast by a guessed correction factor nor treat the sample error fraction as the corpus's DS1/DS2 error rate.

An exact worst-case label-perturbation check makes that remaining fragility concrete. Hold all 15,948 DS1/DS2 episodes' recorded RS1/RS2 outcomes fixed, and permit only a change in the *severity* label within these two classes. We seek the minimum number of adversarial reclassifications making the pooled visibly-resolved rate for DS2 no greater than for DS1. Exactly **223** targeted flips suffice: reclassify 223 of the 330 original DS2/RS1 episodes as DS1/RS1, leaving the recorded outcomes untouched. The resulting rates are 107/1,138=9.40% for DS2 and 1,397/14,810=9.43% for DS1. Exhaustive integer enumeration of all directionally helpful combinations confirms that 222 or fewer flips cannot erase the pooled sign under this restricted two-class model. The threshold is 1.40% of all 15,948 class-eligible labels, *but the witness concentrates changes in 223/330 = 67.6% of the visibly resolved DS2 records*; for SpecStory alone the minimum is 170 records, and for SWE alone it is 55. The witness is *adversarial and deliberately concentrated among visible DS2 outcomes*: it is not evidence that these labels are wrong, that a 1.40% random error rate would reverse the result, or that this particular error pattern is likely. Thus the association is stable across observed clusters but not robust to unrestricted targeted label errors. Appendix A.4 records the exact integer search and assumptions.

For a severity group $g \in \{\mathrm{DS1}, \mathrm{DS2}\}$, write r_g for the observed fraction with resolver label RV2 and u_g for the fraction with unknown final resolution. Without restrictions on missing outcomes, the eventual fraction θ_g and the group difference satisfy

$$r_g \le \theta_g \le r_g + u_g, \qquad r_{\mathrm{DS2}} - (r_{\mathrm{DS1}} + u_{\mathrm{DS1}}) \le \theta_{\mathrm{DS2}} - \theta_{\mathrm{DS1}} \le (r_{\mathrm{DS2}} + u_{\mathrm{DS2}}) - r_{\mathrm{DS1}}. \tag{1}$$

These are sharp logical limits for the stated labels: every endpoint is attained by assigning appropriate outcomes to currently unknown cases. They do not make missing-outcome assumptions or identify causal effects.

The most important counter-result concerns *eventual* resolution. Among DS1 there are 1,080 cases visibly marked `RV2` (agent resolution after pushback), and among DS2 there are 296. If every case without visible resolution may or may not eventually have resolved after pushback, the all-episode RV2 fraction lies between 7.40% and 99.36% for DS1, and between 21.75% and 97.50% for DS2. The logically permissible DS2-minus-DS1 eventual difference therefore spans about *minus 77.61* to *plus 90.10* percentage points. This bound contains large negative and positive values: the observed severity ordering of *visibility* places no sign restriction on the eventual recovery contrast. Conditioning on visibly resolved outcomes creates still another target: 1,080/1,174 (91.99%) in DS1 versus 296/330 (89.70%) in DS2 are marked RV2.

A sensitivity frontier makes the missing-outcome requirement explicit. Let q_1 and q_2 denote the fractions of currently unknown DS1 and DS2 episodes, respectively, that would eventually receive resolver label RV2 if their terminal outcomes were observed. The implied DS2-minus-DS1 eventual difference is

$$\Delta(q_1, q_2) = \left(\frac{296}{1361} + \frac{1031}{1361} q_2\right) - \left(\frac{1080}{14587} + \frac{13413}{14587} q_1\right). \tag{2}$$

The zero-difference frontier is $q_1 = 0.1560 + 0.8238 q_2$. Thus, if no unknown DS2 case eventually resolved after pushback ($q_2 = 0$), the observed ordering would be erased once more than 15.60% of unknown DS1 cases did; if $q_2 = 0.50$, the corresponding DS1 threshold is 56.79%; and if $q_2 = 1$, it is 97.98%. Under the special symmetry assumption $q_1 = q_2 = q$, the sign reverses only above $q = 88.56\%$. These are tipping points under stated assumptions, not estimates of the unknown rates. Without such a restriction, the sign remains unidentified. None of these comparisons licenses calling unknown RS2 labels failures or treating the original labels as independently validated ground truth.

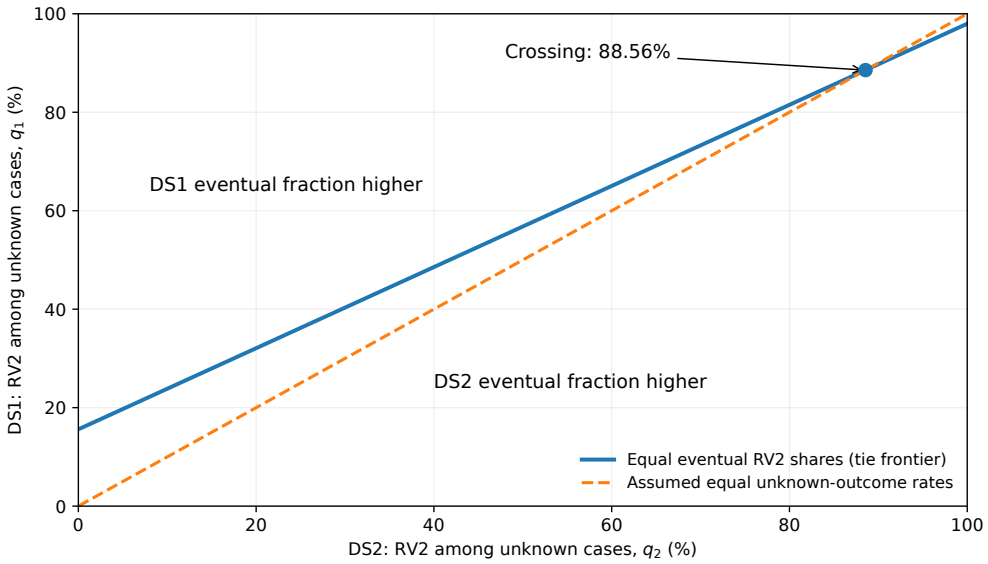


Figure 1: Assumption-dependent sign boundary for the eventual DS2–DS1 after-pushback resolution contrast. The solid line gives values of (q_2, q_1) at which the two fractions tie; points above it favor DS1 and below it favor DS2. The dashed line represents the unverified equal-unknown-rate assumption. The intersection is a sensitivity threshold, not a measured missing-outcome rate.

3.4 Partial identification of eventual post-pushback recovery

The missing final-outcome labels give a precise example of why complete file reproducibility is not equivalent to identifying a population outcome. Let $N = 16{,}118$ be the number of admitted episodes, $R = 1{,}376$ the number with a *visible* agent correction after developer pushback, and $U = 14{,}614$ the number whose final resolution is unknown. If R^* counts episodes eventually resolved by an agent after developer pushback, then the observed statuses alone imply

$$\frac{R}{N} \le \frac{R^*}{N} \le \frac{R+U}{N}, \qquad 0.08537 \le \frac{R^*}{N} \le 0.99206. \tag{3}$$

The bounds follow the standard partial-identification principle for missing outcomes: retain the observed classifications and allow each unknown outcome to fall on either side of the target [44]. They do *not* assume missingness at random or specify a predictive model. Thus the source's 91.49% conditional figure remains correct for the 1,504 visibly resolved episodes, while neither the proposition that most *all* episodes eventually recover after pushback nor its converse follows from the released resolution labels. The interval is a deterministic logical bound, not a confidence interval. A narrower empirical interval would require an outcome trace or a justified constraint on the 14,614 unknown cases; ordinary bootstrapping of the observed labels cannot provide that information.

This distinction is consequential for source comparisons. Studies reporting an intervention success rate conditional on an observed risk event address a well-defined selected population; studies with unobserved terminal outcomes cannot be pooled with them by renaming unknown as failure. The same issue occurs in observational oversight work when human intervention is preferentially triggered by difficult runs. It is a target-definition problem, not evidence that the original authors misstated their recorded counts.

4 Contextual comparisons: observed event, actor and endpoint

These selected studies are not a sampled review universe or an independent validation dataset. They delimit which intervention outcomes can be compared with the visibility outcome in Section 3. We do not pool their success rates or claim that the contrasts below originated in this reanalysis.

4.1 Requests, permissions and execution states

An agent asking for information does not imply that a person answered during evaluation. HiL-Bench's 300 tasks and 1,131 blockers use a frozen matcher and stored blocker resolutions, despite human involvement in task construction [12]. Learning to Ask, Ask-before-Plan and structured-uncertainty clarification similarly operationalize model-mediated or constructed respondents, under different information and task protocols [25, 31, 26]. Agentic Abstention instead treats asking as an episode-ending withholding action; AgentAbstain and Designing for Doubt further distinguish whether abstention is warranted by the task state [13, 28, 33]. A direct human–simulator comparison, using 495 human dialogue traces across 165 tasks, shows why simulator fidelity must be checked for the particular target outcome rather than assumed from benchmark design [32].

A permission judgment and a completed state change likewise differ. DelegationBench has human majority decisions for 149/156 labeled scenarios but runs tool execution separately in a sandbox; its reporting protocol already recognizes the transition from decision to action [11]. AuthGateBench assesses policy-conditioned allow/block judgments, whereas AuthorizationBench evaluates tool use against policies in 286 mock-service tasks and 6,864 model runs [23, 27]. Tool-call overuse and hindsight-distilled sentinels test further action or pause decisions, not live-user authorization [24, 34]. In an action-matching subset of DelegationCheck, 600/1,011 observed selected-tool episodes satisfy a stricter tool-and-argument match; this remains a sandbox fidelity statistic, not a human-consent or harm-prevention rate [11]. An apparently useful clarification can also expand the prompt-injection surface through an untrusted reply channel, as investigated by ASPI [35]. The underlying operation and allowed evidence matter more than the label "ask" or "approve".

4.2 Human checking, correction and opportunity for failure

Oversight should separate occurrence, detection, intervention and final outcome. In Looks Fine to Me, 65/71 seeded-defect episodes involved additional evaluation but only 28/71 ended in a corrected defect: checking and correction are different measured events [14]. A controlled computer-use study assigned 48 people to 192 sessions across four oversight strategies [16]. Let O denote a problematic-action occurrence, I successful correction among occurrence sessions, and F a final uncorrected failure. Under the reported exhaustive three-way partition, the accounting identity is

$$P(F) = P(O)[1 - P(I \mid O)]. \tag{4}$$

The published rounded margins reconstruct 54 no-occurrence sessions, 29 occurrence-plus-successful-correction sessions, and 109 uncorrected sessions; 29/138 is the correction fraction among occurrence sessions, not 29/192. The reported strategy differences in final failure and conditional intervention are not interchangeable, and the original participant-clustered model was not independently refitted here. This identity is not a causal mediation estimate.

Observational traces introduce their own selection. In Here Let Me Help, 30 people produced 360 sessions, while 309 stop events, 315 reasons and 322 type–reason pairings have different denominators [15]. Intervention can be preferentially triggered by difficult runs; such sessions need not be comparable with sessions where no intervention occurred. Other agent interaction traces and interview studies similarly reveal user practices without randomized intervention

effects or measured labor savings [36, 37, 38]. Accordingly, stronger claims about improved safety require an outcome-matched comparator and assignment design, not merely human involvement [22].

4.3 Attention, elapsed time and subjective oversight burden

Human burden is measured with non-equivalent instruments. TiCoder reports correctness and subjective workload in a bounded code-generation user study without an established task-time gain [21]. Cocoa compares how a small group apportions time between inspection and co-execution, while When Should Users Check? reports controlled elapsed task times, not separately timed real-work labor [22, 17]. Ask Less Ask Better reduces a judged attention-cost proxy by 36–73% under specified budgets, but the proxy is not stopwatch-measured answering effort [19]. A deployed proactive assistant's message-response share of 40.5% across 22,594 observed on-call sessions similarly does not identify corrected incidents or human-hours saved [30]. Evidence about job performance, simulator transfer and assistance channels therefore remains task-specific [20, 32].

Even a human approval can be an influenced judgment. An industry study reports alignment with randomized intermediate agent preferences across 50 professionals, while a stylized fatigue-capacity study relies on stipulated reviewer behavior and LLM personas rather than measured inter-human fatigue [39, 40]. Other human–agent collaboration studies show that who leads, when they intervene, and which state they observe matter to interpretation [45, 46]. This contextual evidence motivates explicit actor and endpoint descriptions; it does not validate the DS1/DS2 taxonomy in our primary corpus.

4.4 Auxiliary documentary consistency checks

We also verified selected displayed counts, operators and release editions in other published agent papers. Appendix B, Table B1, preserves the bounded recalculations for dark-pattern supervision, computer-use oversight, PULSE, DRIFT-BENCH, CAR-bench and ClarifyBench [18, 16, 41, 42, 43, 26]. In particular, discrepancies between a printed table and an ordinary arithmetic recomputation are *source-verification holds*, not replication of the original model pipeline. We move these secondary checks outside the main results because they do not identify eventual resolution in Tang and colleagues' released records [29].

5 Discussion: interpretation and limitations

The contextual comparisons support the distinction between a measured event and a downstream benefit; they are not additional validation observations for the source-labelled severity contrast. The question is not whether every experiment should observe deployment. Rather, the reported claim should stay within the experiment's actor, state, counterfactual and endpoint. Table 2 separates experimental objects, while Appendix B preserves auxiliary documentary consistency checks without making them co-primary outcomes. This synthesis does not produce a new composite benchmark score: assigning quality weights to different original study designs would replace identifiable source conditions with a judgment that has not been externally validated.

Three implications follow for interpreting and designing studies. *First*, when comparing policies for asking or abstaining, experiments should hold the available policy, task information, tools and question budget constant, or identify those differences explicitly. A tool-call bias measured as an offline next-action selection cannot be treated as a field safety endpoint merely because an activation-steering intervention improves the correct no-call class [24]. Likewise, controlled shared-control mazes with four human operators and repeated trials can reveal adaptive allocation under route advantage but not a general benefit to all workplace users [45].

Second, intervention studies should report the transition they change, rather than using a generic notion of success. For a risky action, distinct outcomes include prevention of occurrence, detection conditional on occurrence, successful correction, rollback and uncorrected final harm. The occurrence–intervention–failure decomposition in Equation 4 displays the necessary denominators, but, without suitable assignment and clustered data, does not identify a causal mechanism behind a final-failure contrast. For clarification, the relevant sequence begins with the first missing fact and continues through useful reply and correct post-reply action. Broader agent evaluations already identify cost, robustness and execution context as distinct axes [5, 6, 46]; future interventions should specify where in that sequence their evidence ends.

Third, claims of human benefit should involve a human-benefit measurement. Lab timing, perceived workload, simulated-user satisfaction, model-judged attentional cost and real user work minutes provide different information. Observational proactive responses or human approvals are not substitute measures of corrected incidents or genuinely independent expert judgment. The distinction is not an argument for discarding simulated benchmarks: they can efficiently and reproducibly test mechanics, provided their generalizability is evaluated rather than presumed [32, 40]. Further scrutiny of evaluation validity is also consistent with existing critiques of outcome-focused agent benchmarks and with procedural approaches that already require explicit source-to-measurement links [7, 8].

5.1 Interpretive and methodological limits

This is a secondary observational reanalysis with purposively selected cross-study source checks, not a systematic review of the field. The 170-family register cannot support fieldwide percentages; its screening statuses are provisional; the twelve detailed cases and later challenge sets are not independent random draws. They are retained only to show why respondent, state, denominator and endpoint distinctions matter when interpreting the primary 16,118-episode result. The A–H trace has not been compared with a human-adjudicated reference standard or tested for sensitivity, specificity or superiority over existing review practices. We do not claim a second human coder or inter-human agreement coefficient.

The empirical checks also have unequal reproducibility depth. Original tables permit exact arithmetic without identifying hidden rounding, task matching, treatment assignments or the authors' clustered statistical models. The complete annotation file permits exact label counts, source stratification and matched-cluster calculations without validating how the labels were originally constructed or determining outcomes never observed. The primary empirical finding is therefore a source-stratified, repository-matched and session-matched descriptive association in the original severity and resolution labels. Only 853/8,590 (9.93%) two-class sessions were matched, representing 2,775/15,948 (17.40%) eligible episodes, and 528 of 553 within-session ties have no visible fix for either class. Matching by session removes only differences in factors constant across episodes within that recorded session. Repository-nested resampling accounts for the higher clustering level in a descriptive way but does not remove episode-level confounding by cause, symptom, timing or annotation mechanisms. The underlying labels have not been independently revalidated by us; unlike a dataset without any quality audit, the source itself reports a limited expert adjudication check, with weaker severity-axis performance in the explicitly cited arXiv v1 edition. Moreover, the source codebook uses the same visible interaction to establish applied damage and explicit correction; this measurement coupling offers a plausible noncausal explanation for part of the visibility contrast. Neither session matching nor clustering separates that common ascertainment process. Its small, imbalanced reference sample cannot estimate error specifically between DS1 and DS2. Our exact 223-label adversarial certificate further demonstrates that the sign of the pooled visibility contrast is conditional on a potentially fragile severity assignment; repository clustering does not address this vulnerability. Moreover, because a case is included only after visible developer pushback, the recorded corpus is neither all agent errors nor a probability sample.

The closest priority constraint is substantive rather than terminological. General evaluation-validity and procedure-aware surveys already provide audit structures [5, 8], and DelegationBench directly recommends a staged judgment-to-state reporting protocol [11]. Original research on user simulators and fatigue modeling likewise establishes respondent- and workload-related limits [32, 40]. Our contribution is the bounded reconstruction and attribution of particular published contrasts, not the first invention of those boundaries. Demonstrating that this approach improves decisions relative to existing review standards would require a separate comparative study.

6 Conclusion

An agent-intervention statistic becomes interpretable only when its actor, decision state, analysis unit, denominator and endpoint are retained. In the pinned 16,118-episode coding-agent release, the DS2–DS1 visible-resolution contrast is large at the episode level and remains positive across both acquisition sources, matched repositories and, more stringently, matched sessions. The same data do not identify the sign of the eventual post-pushback recovery difference because most terminal outcomes are unknown. The sensitivity frontier shows exactly which assumptions about those unknown outcomes would be required to preserve or reverse the observed ordering; under equal unknown-case recovery rates, reversal occurs only above 88.56%, but that equality is itself unobserved. The source's 91.49% after-pushback figure remains valid for visibly resolved episodes and cannot establish an all-episode recovery majority. The observed contrast can be reversed under a deliberately adversarial 223-label stress test, concentrating on 67.6% of the visibly resolved DS2 records; this is a mathematical sensitivity witness, not evidence of observed annotation mistakes or a calibrated error rate. These results strengthen a reproducible descriptive reanalysis without turning severity into a causal exposure or treating published annotation checks as our independent validation. Generalized agent safety, saved human labor and superiority over previous audit frameworks remain untested.

A Technical Methods and Source-Integrity Audit

Status and scope. This appendix documents deterministic reanalysis of a public annotation file and post-hoc descriptive stability checks. It is *not* independent label validation, a human-coder study, a systematic literature sample, or an estimate of causal severity effects. The original author-annotated rows are not redistributed.

A.1 Frozen data, provenance, and admission gates

The unique source is the public annotation object supporting Tang et al., *How Coding Agents Fail Their Users: A Large-Scale Analysis of Developer–Agent Misalignment in 20,574 Real-World Sessions* (EMNLP 2026; DOI 10.18653/2026.emnlp-main.1011). Our calculation uses the fixed code-release commit and path:
Pinned GitHub source file.
Commit: `c887cc920129b2db0bdf218c8550e98f74f42f7c`.
Path: `data/core/annotated_misalignments.json`.
Source SHA-256:
`7e0693675242a625bdb586bcd8cef23f5da76c65cf840108c3c24b6b479b9f57`.

The source has 16,118 episode objects. Each composite episode key (source, repository, session, misalignment) is distinct. The observed resolver labels agree structurally with resolution status: the 1,504 records marked RS1 have one RV1/RV2/RV3 resolver; the 14,614 records marked RS2 have null resolver. The source creates its own severity and resolution labels; no reannotation is performed here. Its observational selection rule requires a mismatch made visible by developer correction or pushback, rather than sampling all failures. The source's arXiv v1 (28 May 2026), Appendix A.2, Table 5, reports on 100 adjudicated records: damage-severity agreement between two source annotators was 0.71, and model-to-gold accuracy was 0.64; the respective resolution-status values were 0.92 and 0.96. These are source-reported per-axis exact-match diagnostics, not a known DS1/DS2 confusion matrix, a full-corpus correction rate, or our own validation. The accepted EMNLP version and released data are distinguished from this archived annotation-quality edition.

Table A1: Preserved source partitions. RS2 is unknown, not failure.

Subset	Episodes	Visible RS1	Visible RV2
DS1 (effort/trust only)	14,587	1,174	1,080
DS2 (easily reversible damage)	1,361	330	296
Other severity classes (DS0/DS3/DS4)	170	0	0
Total	16,118	1,504	1,376

Observation–classification coupling. The original codebook requires evidence of an applied, reversible code/state change for DS2, while RS1 requires visible confirmation of correction. Both labels are inferred from the same textual record. This leaves open common-visibility and classification mechanisms even after repository/session matching; the source provides no linked dual-annotator DS1/DS2 confusion matrix to separate them.

A.2 Units, weights and dependence

Our primary descriptive endpoint is $Y_i = \mathbf{1}\{\text{resolution_status}_i = \text{RS1}\}$, where $Y = 0$ means no recorded visible resolution rather than known failure. In a session s containing both classes, define $D_s = \bar{Y}_{\text{DS2},s} - \bar{Y}_{\text{DS1},s}$. The equal-session estimator is $\bar{D}_S = |S|^{-1} \sum_{s \in S} D_s$. The matched sample comprises 853 sessions and 2,775 episodes in 352 source-qualified repositories. The equal-session estimate is 0.1396122927. The matching gate admits 853/8,590 (9.93%) sessions

and 2,775/15,948 (17.40%) eligible episodes, across 352/1,229 source-qualified repository keys. The signed difference is positive in 201 sessions, negative in 99, and tied in 553. Of the ties, 528 have zero visible-resolution rates for both severity groups, 22 have rates of one for both, and 3 have equal intermediate rates. The data are nonrandom and this admitted subset is not representative by design.

To preserve clustering beyond the session level, the repository-nested descriptive bootstrap selects 352 source–repository clusters with replacement, keeping *all* matched sessions within each draw. The equal-session mean is recomputed over the resampled sessions (3,000 draws; fixed seed 993720); the 2.5th and 97.5th nearest-order percentiles are $[0.1071711681, 0.1729976896]$. The older whole-session resampling interval, $[0.1090339418, 0.1702394909]$ (seed 993719), is shown only for comparison because sessions are nested in repositories. The alternative equal-repository estimator gives each of the 352 repository means of session differences equal weight: 0.1405407792, with repository-resampling percentiles $[0.1017798217, 0.1809355907]$.

Table A2: Nested robustness endpoints (all values in percentage points). Each interval is a descriptive resampling band for this observed nonrandom file.

Restriction/weighting	Sessions	Repos	Mean	Repo-level 2.5–97.5 band
All paired sessions, equal session	853	352	+13.96	+10.72 to +17.30
All paired sessions, equal repository	853	352	+14.05	+10.18 to +18.09
Extraction confidence = high	801	339	+14.30	+10.87 to +17.66
Exactly one episode of each class	307	171	+16.94	+11.73 to +22.36

Removing each repository in turn from the 853-session calculation yields an equal-session mean in $[0.1355586404, 0.1435967878]$. In the matched sessions, the DS2 rate exceeds the DS1 rate in 201 sessions, is lower in 99, and ties in 553. The original `confidence` attribute measures support for episode extraction, not certainty of damage-severity coding. Subset comparisons were chosen *after* viewing available fields, are exploratory, and may select a nonrepresentative fraction of the file. No adjustment for an exploratory search over many candidates is claimed; no inferential p-values are reported.

A.3 Logical bounds and assumption frontier

Let r_g be the visible RV2 share among all episodes in severity group g, and u_g the fraction with unknown final status. Define $q_g \in [0, 1]$ as a *hypothetical* eventual RV2 fraction among currently unknown cases. Then

$$\theta_g = r_g + u_g q_g, \qquad \Delta = \theta_{\mathrm{DS2}} - \theta_{\mathrm{DS1}} = \left(\frac{296 + 1031 q_2}{1361}\right) - \left(\frac{1080 + 13413 q_1}{14587}\right).$$

Without assumptions, $\Delta \in [-0.7760687641, 0.9009798414]$; the endpoints are logically sharp completions of currently unknown cases, not probabilistic uncertainty limits. The exact zero-difference frontier has the form

$$q_1 = \frac{296/1361 - 1080/14587}{13413/14587} + \frac{1031/1361}{13413/14587} q_2 \approx 0.1560 + 0.8238 q_2.$$

The special restriction $q_1 = q_2 = q$ gives $q = 0.8856$ as a sign crossing. Without a defensible restriction on q_1, q_2, the sign of eventual recovery is not identified. Figure 1 in the main text visualizes this algebra; it is not a fitted empirical curve.

A.4 Worst-case severity-reclassification certificate

This check is separate from the missing-eventual-outcome model in Appendix A.3. We hold the observed binary RS1/RS2 outcomes fixed and allow the source severity label to move between

Table A3: Illustrative *assumption* thresholds, not observed recovery estimates.

q_2: unknown DS2 RV2 share	q_1 threshold for a tie
0%	15.60%
25%	36.20%
50%	56.79%
75%	77.39%
100%	97.98%

DS1 and DS2 (no DS0/DS3/DS4 changes). The observed 2-by-2 table is DS1 (RS1=1,174; RS2=13,413) and DS2 (RS1=330; RS2=1,031). To lower the observed DS2-minus-DS1 difference, it can be beneficial to move an RS1 from DS2 to DS1 (count x) or an RS2 from DS1 to DS2 (count y). Moves in the reverse directions only increase the positive contrast until crossing. Under the allowed changes, the modified comparison is

$$\frac{330 - x}{1361 - x + y} \leq \frac{1174 + x}{14587 + x - y}, \quad 0 \leq x \leq 330, \quad 0 \leq y \leq 13413.$$

We enumerate integer $k = x + y = 0, 1, \ldots$ and all feasible pairs $0 \leq x \leq k$ using exact cross-multiplication, stopping at the first non-positive difference. The first witness occurs at $k = 223$, $(x, y) = (223, 0)$; all $k < 223$ fail the inequality. The witness produces 107/1,138 (9.4025%) versus 1,397/14,810 (9.4328%), respectively, and alters 223/15,948 (1.3983%) original two-class labels; these 223 switches are also 67.58% of the 330 originally visibly resolved DS2 cases. The latter denominator highlights the concentrated adversarial nature of the witness, not a measured mislabeling prevalence. Restricting the same exercise to each acquisition source separately yields the following exact minima:

Stratum	DS1 visible/N	DS2 visible/N	Min. flips	Fraction of eligible labels
Pooled	1,174/14,587	330/1,361	223	1.3983%
SpecStory	833/10,861	255/1,107	170	1.4205%
SWE	341/3,726	75/254	55	1.3819%

The source validation sample does not tell us whether even one such targeted flip is actually warranted. Consequently these minima are *worst-case algebraic perturbation budgets, not estimated annotation error rates, not adjusted results, and not confidence limits.* The observed endpoint depends on classification validity; the unknown eventual recovery endpoint remains separately unidentified even if every severity label were flawless.

A.5 Reproduction and claim gates

Run the scripts with Python 3 (standard library only), after obtaining `annotated_misalignments.json` from the pinned author source. Use the exact source file above; the scripts reject any other SHA-256. *From the public GitHub repository root*, use the `scripts/` paths:

```
python scripts/reproduce_visibility_robustness.py \
  --annotations /path/to/annotated_misalignments.json \
  --output visibility_check.json
python scripts/reproduce_nested_robustness.py \
  --annotations /path/to/annotated_misalignments.json \
  --output nested_check.json
python scripts/reproduce_matched_coverage.py \
  --annotations /path/to/annotated_misalignments.json \
  --output coverage_check.json
python scripts/verify_replay.py nested_check.json \
  results/aggregate_results.json
```

In the *Overleaf source ZIP*, the three analysis scripts sit at the ZIP root rather than in `scripts/`; omit that prefix for a local extracted-archive replay, and check the original aggregate JSON against the bundled `MR22_Aggregate_Results.json`. The new `MR26_Matched_Coverage_Results.json` is additional descriptive evidence, not a replacement for the locked original aggregate output. The JSON output is aggregate-only and includes a deterministic integer-search certificate for minimum severity relabeling budgets. The script enumerates all outcome-concordant DS1/DS2 switches, verifies each candidate by exact integer cross-products, and keeps RS1/RS2 fixed. The complete source records are never copied into the public manuscript or supplementary ZIP. The post-hoc checks are explicitly marked exploratory. Assertions enforce the frozen input, source partitions, 414 mixed-label repositories, 853 mixed-label sessions, 352 repositories supporting those sessions, 801 high-confidence mixed-label sessions, and 307 one-to-one mixed-label sessions.

Interpretive holds. Neither a repository bootstrap nor matching across recorded sessions can validate the authors' original DS1/DS2 classification, determine RS2 terminal outcomes, or support causal intervention estimates. The original source's 91.49% post-pushback resolution proportion is valid *only conditional on the visibly resolved 1,504 episodes.* Source-reported validation on the severity axis is materially weaker than on the resolution-status axis in the explicitly identified May 2026 arXiv v1, and no new human reannotation is claimed in this work. Publisher template updates, authorship, CRediT, funding, conflict declaration, exact AI-use disclosure and author-approved persistent public deposit remain separate administrative checks.

B Contextual Source-Table and Release-Edition Checks

Published aggregate metrics can be reconstructed without rerunning an agent; the scope of that reconstruction must be reported just as carefully as the result. Table B1 distinguishes checks on displayed tables from a complete recount of released categorical labels. In particular, a source-internal table discrepancy is not evidence that the original experimental pipeline was wrong, whereas an incomplete outcome ascertainment problem can persist even when every released record has been counted.

Table B1: Bounded reconstructions from published tables or publicly released labels. Counts reflect the study-specific eligible units; none estimates a fieldwide error rate.

Source and evidence	Independent check	Interpretive boundary
Dark Patterns, Table 3 [18]	Across 16 categories: 10 strictly better under supervision, 4 tied, 2 worse; 14 are non-worse.	A non-worse count is not 14 strict improvements or statistical significance across categories.
Computer-use oversight, tables [16]	Among 192 sessions: 54 no occurrence, 29 successful interventions and 109 uncorrected.	Recounts do not replicate participant-clustered inference or identify a causal pathway.
PULSE, seven printed score pairs [41]	Ordinary unweighted Pearson $r = +0.302898$; table and prose present negative values (-0.18 and -0.11).	Printed-pair calculation does not reconstruct the unreported original regression or rating-to-arm experiment.
DRIFT-BENCH, publisher tables [42]	One cell prints 46.33 without and 65.33 with clarification, but gain +9.00 rather than arithmetic +19.00.	The discrepancy is in printed table arithmetic, not a rerun of agent rollouts.
Developer–agent misalignment release [29]	16,118 labels: 1,504 visibly resolved, 14,614 unknown; eventual after-pushback share bounded by 8.54–99.21%.	The 91.49% reported among visible resolutions is conditional; the wide logical bounds do not validate the source classifier.
CAR-bench editions [43]	Published task groups $100 + 90 + 50 = 240$; later competition groups $100 + 98 + 56 = 254$.	Different releases cannot be pooled as one task sample without record matching.
ClarifyBench, Table 2 [26]	Printed total 716; explicit 241, ambiguous 213 and infeasible 198 sum to 652, leaving 64 unallocated by the printed categories.	This does not show why the 64 are unaccounted for or that the raw experiment omitted them.

B.1 An operator or edition can change a source claim

The source prose in Dark Patterns Meet GUI Agents describes fourteen of sixteen dark-pattern tasks as less susceptible under human supervision. Its printed avoidance-rate rows, however, yield ten strict increases, four ties and two decreases. Fourteen is the count of non-worse rows, not of strictly improved rows [18]. Importantly, participants in the oversight arm watched prerecorded Operator trajectories, with pauses and confirmations simulated by the interviewer; the experiment does not test whether a live agent would have adapted after each intervention. This qualifies the interpretation of the direction count without erasing the observed supervised-condition benefits or the original study's qualitative analysis. Category directions alone do not supply within-participant significance tests.

For DRIFT-BENCH, the final ICML publisher edition and an earlier preprint contain related but noninterchangeable tables. The publisher's printed gain for one GPT-5.2 parameter-fault cell is ten percentage points lower than its displayed with-minus-without arithmetic [42]. Its service-oriented appendix also contains both positive and negative clarification contrasts, so a blanket statement that clarification always helps or always hurts is unsupported. The original model-level and persona-specific inputs required to resolve the publisher's printed discrepancies are not available here. Reanalysis of a small, selected model roster cannot support population-level significance simply by adjusting multiple p-values; consequently we omit those exploratory significance calculations from the main scientific argument and retain them only in the internal evidence archive.

An especially clear operator distinction appears in CAR-bench. On the publisher's original 50 disambiguation tasks, the printed GPT-5 Pass@3 = 68% corresponds to 34 tasks with at least one success in three runs, while $\text{Pass}^3 = 36\%$ corresponds to 18 tasks successful in all three runs [43]. These metrics answer different consistency questions. The publisher narrative also

uses the label Pass@5 at one location for the value defined as Pass@3 in the source methods and table; this is a source-label conflict, not proof of additional undocumented trials. The later 254-task competition inventory is a different release from the 240-task paper and should be identified as such. In the published ClarifyBench table, domain-specific differences between the stated domain totals and the three enumerated query-type counts sum to 64; the source table alone cannot determine whether a fourth category, omitted rows or another reporting convention explains them [26]. These checks illustrate why a numerator or printed label requires a versioned denominator before comparative interpretation.

B.2 What a public feature release cannot reproduce

PULSE combines observed developer feedback with prediction-assisted evaluation to compare software-agent designs and reports a reduction in confidence-interval width across its experiments [41]. The seven published benchmark-versus-user-score pairs have an ordinary Pearson correlation of +0.302898 when recomputed from the printed values, whereas the published summary gives a negative sign. This sign difference is not explained by ordinary rounding of those displayed pairs. It nevertheless does not establish which transformation, weighting or unrounded records the authors used; the original calculation is a source-verification HOLD rather than a demonstrated error in their broader design comparison. The inspected public feature release contains 1,746 rated rows against 1,747 mentioned in the paper, but lacks the user-level treatment-arm joins and original fitted model inputs needed to rerun its four prediction-powered effect estimates. The reported original intervals and reduction are therefore attributed to the authors, not independently reproduced here.

Declarations (author review only)

Author contributions: CRediT roles and author identities pending confirmation.
Funding and conflicts: To be verified by the human authors.
Data and code: Public reanalysis code, non-identifying aggregate results, and smoke tests: https://github.com/shaikhamalkawi-ux/99llm-agent-oversight-reanalysis. Original annotation data must be obtained from Tang et al.'s author-pinned source; no original third-party episode rows are redistributed.
AI assistance: ChatGPT assisted literature selection, source checking, code construction, analysis, and writing. Human authors must verify outputs and approve the precise disclosure and all findings.

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